

The A2J Infrastructure Moment

What just became possible—and what the
A2J community can now build together.

120M

legal problems/year
not fairly resolved

3.6M

eviction filings/year
3% of tenants have a lawyer

92%

of low-income legal needs
get no help at all

The Problem Has Two Parts

The Scale of the Gap

92% of low-income legal problems get no help at all

97% of eviction defendants have no attorney (80%+ of landlords do)

3.6M eviction filings/year—more than one every 9 seconds

The Old Model Was Broken

- Tenant Power Toolkit (CA): 50+ attorneys, 2 years, California only. Doesn't port to Texas.
- MADE (MA), Teny (NY), Who Owns What (NYC): each team rebuilt from scratch what others had already built.
- Static training data: chatbots guessed at the law with no live retrieval, no citations, no auditability.

"A key challenge lies in scalability across geographies—most tools serve one city or region." — Shelterforce, June 2025

In 2026, the missing piece arrived.

Anthropic released an open-source plugin and MCP connector framework. What used to take a team of engineers and months of work can now be built by one nontechnical attorney in days.

SHARED PLUGIN FRAMEWORK

Skills and workflow logic written once, deployed everywhere. Works across jurisdictions without one-off solutions for each state. Every new contribution improves every deployment.

LIVE MCP LEGAL CONNECTORS

CourtListener, Legal Data Hunter, Lawve AI: real-time statute and case law retrieval—replacing static, outdated AI training data. Every answer is grounded in cited, verifiable source text.

PORTABILITY ACROSS JURISDICTIONS

Same reasoning engine. Same workflow logic. California to Texas is a rules file swap, not a new engineering project. 50 states = 50 data files, not 50 isolated builds.

NO AI MODEL LOCK-IN

Plugins and skills are designed to be portable across foundational AI models—not locked to Anthropic. The A2J community's investment is in shared infrastructure, not a single vendor.

DETERMINISTIC SAFETY

Legal rules are encoded as explicit structured data, not predicted by AI. The system checks facts against rules—it doesn't guess. Transparent, auditable, and updateable as law changes.

ONE PERSON, DAYS NOT YEARS

A nontechnical attorney built a working 3-state prototype in days for \$0. The old model of expensive, siloed, years-long projects is no longer the only path.

Before the demo — five things to know:

1

Speed and cost

A nontechnical attorney built this in days for essentially \$0. The old model of years-long team projects is no longer the only path.

2

Open-source, no lock-in

This runs on an open-source plugin framework. Skills and plugins are portable across AI models—not locked to Anthropic or any single vendor.

3

Live law retrieval

This tool does not guess at the law. It retrieves the current statute text in real time. Every citation links directly to the source.

4

Portability across states

The same workflow logic applies to California, Texas, and New York. Changing the state means swapping a data file—not rewriting the tool.

5

Safety built in by design

Rules are deterministic, not predictive—explicit if/then logic, not AI inference. Transparency, citations, and referrals to attorneys are part of the architecture from the start.

Meet Maria.

Restaurant worker. Los Angeles. Three years in the same apartment.

- 10pm. She opens her door. A notice is taped to it.
- It demands \$2,050: \$1,850 in rent, plus \$200 in late fees.
- She has 3 days. She Googles. She finds legal jargon. She panics.
- She calls the legal aid hotline. Multi-day wait. She's on her own.
- **She doesn't know: the \$200 late fee may make the entire notice void under California law.**

THREE-DAY NOTICE TO PAY RENT OR QUIT

TO:	Maria [Tenant]
PROPERTY:	1234 Elm St, Apt 4 Los Angeles, CA
RENT OWED:	\$1,850.00
LATE FEES:	\$200.00
TOTAL DUE:	\$2,050.00
COMPLY BY:	3 days from service

POSSIBLE DEFECT: Late fees included in notice amount may void this notice.
[CCP Section 1161(2)]

How It Works: Three Layers

Each layer has a different job. None is complete without the others. The key insight: only Layer 3 is missing at scale.

1 ANTHROPIC BUILDS & MAINTAINS

The Model + Infrastructure

Claude model
Plugin/MCP framework
CourtListener (case law)
Legal Data Hunter (statutes)
Lawve AI (skills marketplace)

This layer already exists.
the project did not build it.

2 the project + COMMUNITY BUILDS

Skills & Workflow Logic

The "how to reason about a legal task" layer: intake questions, defect screening logic, output templates, safety guardrails.

Portable across states without rewriting.
Portable across AI models without rewriting.

This is the eviction-triage SKILL.md.

3 the project PRIORITY CONTRIBUTION

Rules Data (JSON)

"IF notice includes late fees, THEN defective under CCP 1161(2)."

Deterministic, not predictive. Explicit, auditable, structured data—not AI guessing.

AI drafts. Experts validate.
50 states. Nobody has done this yet.

The JSON Rules File: Why It Matters

This 45-line file encodes California eviction notice law as machine-readable decision logic. It is the project's first major community contribution—and a model for 50 states.

ca_eviction_rules_v0.1.json

```
{ "notice_type": "3-Day Pay or Quit",
  "statute": "CCP Section 1161(2)",
  "defect_triggers": [{
    "id": "CA-DEFECT-01",
    "description": "Notice includes
      late fees or non-rent charges",
    "rule": "Amount must be unpaid
      rent ONLY. Late fees = VOID.",
    "confidence": "HIGH",
    "priority": "CRITICAL"
  }]
}
```

What makes this different:

Before

AI inferred rules from training data—opaque, stale, not auditable, potentially hallucinated.

Now

Rules are explicit structured data. Deterministic, not predictive. A judge can inspect exactly what rule fired.

Portable

Swap ca_rules.json for tx_rules.json. Same reasoning engine. New state. No new engineering.

Scalable

AI drafts a state file in hours. Expert validates in days. Every deployment everywhere benefits.

What the Demo Shows — and What the Community Builds Next

Honesty about gaps is not a weakness. Every gap is a community project waiting to happen.

What this demo demonstrates

Live statute retrieval—real-time, cited, verifiable

Modular, portable architecture: CA to TX to NY

Deterministic rules checking—not AI hallucination

Speed: nontechnical attorney, days not years

Portability across AI models—no vendor lock-in

Safety + transparency built into the architecture

Gaps = community projects

Full 50-state rules coverage (47 states still to build + validate)

Complete workflow: notice to Answer to hearing prep

Attorney-validated rules—expert review still needed per state

Multilingual support—Maria may speak Spanish or Tagalog

Court system integration (Tyler Odyssey etc.)—Phase 2

A solved A2J problem—this is a powerful first step, not a finish line

The Opportunity

The talent exists. The domain expertise exists. The community exists.

What's missing is coordination and ignition—and that's exactly what this effort is built to provide.

Ignite and coordinate the community

Legal aid orgs, law schools, courts, and funders each have pieces of the puzzle. A coordinating entity connects them around a shared technical agenda—ending isolated reinvention and multiplying every contribution.

Lead the 50-state JSON rules project

AI drafts fast. Attorneys validate. the project coordinates the expert review network, manages versioning, and ensures every state's rules stay current as law changes. Nobody has built this yet.

Set standards for safe A2J AI

Validation protocols, accuracy eval frameworks, deployment playbooks, certification standards—so the A2J community builds on a trusted foundation rather than reinventing safety practices independently.

Partner with Anthropic (and beyond)

The community brings domain expertise and validation capacity. Anthropic brings infrastructure. Together: safe, accurate, scalable legal help—not in decades, but in months. Designed to work across AI models.

The Ask

The infrastructure gap is closed. The community exists. The work is defined.

What this project needs now is partners who understand that infrastructure investment multiplies impact 50x.

A2J organizations + legal aid leaders

Contribute domain expertise to the 50-state JSON rules validation project. You know the law in your jurisdiction. AI drafts the rules files in hours; your expert validation makes them safe and trustworthy.

Law schools + clinics

Assign students and fellows to validate rules files and build A2J skills as supervised legal work—impactful, structured, exactly the kind of learning great clinics exist to produce.

Funders

Fund the coordination layer, not just individual projects. Infrastructure investment creates shared returns. Seed funding for the project Phase 1 creates multiplied impact across every A2J deployment.

Anthropic + AI companies

Partner with the project as the community coordination layer for the A2J legal plugin pillar. You built the infrastructure. Help us build the community that fills it with validated, safe A2J content—across AI models.